

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The 49ers followed the gold rush to California!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about history and civilization.
- I can compare two related events or actions.
- I can talk about an unusual or unique event in life.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about the gold rush in California?
- What do you think the conditions were like for people looking for gold in 1849?





Let's Explore!

This letter was from a **miner*** to his wife back home.

* A "miner" is someone who digs for metal deep in the earth.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Have you ever heard of the "gold rush" or the "Klondike"? In 1848, gold was found in California. Here is a letter from one of the miners to his family back home.

My Dearest Janey,

Although I have just been here awhile, I am still learning how to survive in this strange atmosphere. So many people have arrived recently that I am lucky to have found a sound place to live, a claim that is my own. Here, I have only just finished my small cabin with a stove, a cot, so I am more comfortable at night than I was in the tent.

When I go to town for supplies I see such sights! Clothing of all descriptions has been strewn all over the ground as if it cost nothing at all, left by those that have moved on as expected to mines further north. Why have shirts that haven't been worn more than once up to now been thrown away?

People haven't wanted to pay for washing so far, so everything is discarded indiscriminately. I haven't seen anyone pick a piece up and take it up yet either. These are as odd times as I ever thought I might experience!

Out on the claim is as lonely a place as any man can stand. There are times when I work that I have lifted my head to realize I haven't spoken a word so far that day! But fear not Janey, I haven't lost my heart up to now. I know you are thinking of me with love as I think of you.

I hide my gold as a squirrel does his winter food. Have you wondered what I've amassed until now? I shall shower you with it when I arrive before the next snowfall.

Your loving husband,
Hiram



Let's Practice!

Living in California at that time must have been a hustle*!

* A "hustle" refers to an energetic or hurried activity.

Instructions: Match the two parts of the sentence from Column A to Column B. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. Have you ever heard of
2. In 1848, gold was
3. I am still learning how
4. I am lucky to have a sound place
5. I shall shower you with gold

COLUMN B

- a. to live, a claim that is my own.
- b. found in California.
- c. when I arrive before the next snowfall.
- d. to survive in this strange atmosphere.
- e. the "gold rush" or the "Klondike"?



Let's Practice!

Have you ever been away from the ones you love? Hiram has!

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. the / "gold / you / rush" / ever / of / Have / heard / ?

2. have / . / been / awhile / just / here / I

3. many / So / people / have / recently. / arrived

4. only / finished / I / small / . / have / just / cabin / my

5. had / Hiram / hasn't / a / yet / . / time / hard





Extension Activity

Watch the movie *White Fang*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch the movie *White Fang* about a young man going to look for gold in the Yukon.
- Choose a scene in the film that you enjoy the most.
- Take notes about the scene.
- Retell the scene to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch the movie *White Fang*.

☐ ☐

I choose a scene in the film to retell.

☐ ☐

I take notes about the scene.

☐ ☐

I retell the scene to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **cot** (noun): a light fold out bed
e.g. I have only just finished my small cabin with a stove, a cot, so I am more comfortable at night than I was in the tent.
- **to strew** (verb): to spread or scatter without care
e.g. Clothing of all descriptions has been strewn all over the ground as if it cost nothing at all.
- **mine** (noun): A hole or tunnel dug into the earth for the purpose of extracting ore.
e.g. Clothing of all descriptions has been left by those that have moved on, as expected, to mines further north.
- **indiscriminately** (adverb): thoughtlessly, without care
e.g. People haven't wanted to pay for washing so far, so everything is discarded indiscriminately.
- **to lose heart** (expression): to lose courage or to want to give up
e.g. But fear not Janey, I haven't lost my heart up to now. I know you are thinking of me with love as I think of you.
- **to amass** (verb): to gather and save
e.g. I hide my gold as a squirrel does his winter food. Have you wondered what I've amassed until now?



Learning Points

Adverbial Clause of Comparison: Manner

When you want to describe how something happens or is done, you can use adverbial clauses of comparison.

Adverbial clauses of comparison of manner are introduced by the relative adverb *as*.

For example:

*The boy speaks **as if he is sick**.*

*It all happened **as I predicted**.*

Examples:

- *Clothing of all descriptions has been strewn the ground as if it cost nothing at all.*
- *These are as odd times as I ever thought I might experience!*
- *Out on the claim is as lonely a place as any man can stand.*
- *I know you are thinking of me with love as I think of you.*
- *I hide my gold as a squirrel does his winter food.*





Learning Points

Present Perfect for Unusual Events

You use the **Present Perfect** tense in variety of ways, but it is always used to make a connection between the past and the present.

In a story, you can use it to refer to events that happened very recently. In these cases, you use words like *just*, *only just* and *recently*.

For example:

Although I have just been here awhile I am still learning how to survive in this strange atmosphere.

You can use the **Present Perfect** in questions to ask about past experience or unusual events:

For example:

Have you wondered what I've amassed until now?

Notice the use of the word *ever* in questions.

You also use words such as *yet*, *up to now*, *so far* and *until now* when you use the **Present Perfect**, since these words and phrases refer to a period of time covering the past to the present.

For example:

There are times when I work that I have lifted my head to realize I haven't spoken a word so far that day!

(You use *yet* in negative statements and in questions).

Examples:

- *Have you ever heard of the "gold rush" or the "Klondike"?*
- *So many people have arrived recently.*
- *Here, I have only just finished my small cabin with a stove and a cot.*
- *Why have shirts that haven't been worn more than once up to now been thrown away?*
- *People haven't wanted to pay for washing so far.*
- *I haven't seen anyone pick a piece up and take it up yet either.*

